



2026 BAHRAIN GRAND PRIX IN MALAYSIA

02 - 04 October 2026

From	The Stewards	Document	59
To	The Team Manager, McLaren Mastercard F1 Team	Date	04 October 2026
		Time	21:46

The Stewards, having received a report from the Race Director, summoned (document 54) and heard from the driver and team representative, have considered the following matter and determine the following:

No / Driver 1 - Lando Norris

Competitor McLaren Mastercard F1 Team

Time 18:08

Session Race

Fact Driving erratically under Safety Car conditions.

Infringement Breach of Articles B5.13.2a of the FIA F1 Regulations and Appendix L, Chapter IV, Articles 2 e) of the International Sporting Code.

Decision Driver: Reprimand (Driving).
This is the driver's 1st reprimand of the season.

Reason The Stewards heard from the driver of Car 1 (Lando Norris), the team representative and reviewed video and in-car video evidence.

While following the Safety Car, NOR approached Turn 1 behind a group of cars. Car 63 (George Russell) had stopped with a mechanical problem ahead of Turn 1, which caused the cars ahead of NOR to slow down. NOR explained that, due to the low sun and resulting visibility conditions, it was difficult to recognise that the cars ahead had started to slow earlier than would normally have been expected.

NOR consequently misjudged his closing speed and approached the cars ahead too quickly. When he realised this, he braked heavily and deliberately steered to the left, onto the kerbs and then into the gravel bed in order to avoid contact with the cars ahead. By driving onto the kerbs, NOR had reduced grip available for braking, which further limited his ability to slow the car. In doing so, NOR momentarily overshot Car 81 (Oscar Piastri), who was directly ahead of him.

The Stewards considered whether this constituted an overtake while the Safety Car was deployed. Although NOR momentarily moved ahead of PIA, this occurred solely as a consequence of NOR leaving the track while taking avoiding action. PIA immediately repassed NOR while NOR was off the track. The Stewards therefore determined that this did not constitute an overtaking manoeuvre and take no further action in respect of this aspect of the incident.

The Stewards also considered that, particularly while driving behind the Safety Car, NOR should have managed the gap to the cars ahead and his closing speed with greater care. The prevailing visibility conditions were circumstances which NOR should have taken into account when determining an appropriate speed and gap to

the cars ahead, rather than a reason which excused the resulting driving. The need for heavy braking and an avoiding manoeuvre into the gravel demonstrated that NOR had not maintained an appropriate margin in the circumstances.

The Stewards therefore determined that NOR had driven erratically in breach of Article B5.13.2a of the FIA F1 Regulations. Such a situation should not arise while driving behind the Safety Car, and NOR was required to maintain a sufficient margin to the cars ahead. However, taking into account that NOR reacted promptly once he recognised the situation and successfully avoided contact, the Stewards consider a Reprimand as appropriate.

The Stewards separately considered NOR's return to the track. Although Car 18 (Lance Stroll) was in relative close proximity, NOR returned progressively and without requiring STR to take avoiding action or otherwise creating an unsafe situation. The Stewards therefore determined that the re-join was safe.

The Stewards also reviewed whether, after having re-joined the track, NOR had overtaken STR while the Safety Car was deployed. The video evidence showed that, as NOR returned from the gravel, he had already crossed the white line with at least one wheel and, as such, was back on track. At this point, he was ahead of STR and at no point did NOR pass STR. Rather, STR approached NOR while NOR was already in the process of returning to the track. The Stewards therefore determined that NOR had not overtaken STR under Safety Car conditions and as such also take no further action for this part of the incident.

Accordingly, the Stewards impose a Reprimand on NOR for erratic driving. No further action is taken in relation to the re-join or the alleged overtake while the Safety Car was deployed.

Competitors are reminded that they have the right to appeal certain decisions of the Stewards, in accordance with Article 15 of the FIA International Sporting Code and Chapter 5 of the FIA Judicial and Disciplinary Rules, within the applicable time limits.

Decisions of the Stewards are taken independently of the FIA and are based solely on the relevant regulations, guidelines and evidence presented.

Gerd Ennser

Mathieu Remmerie

Pedro Lamy

Mazen Al Hilli

The Stewards